AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS X EXAMINATION

MAY 2016

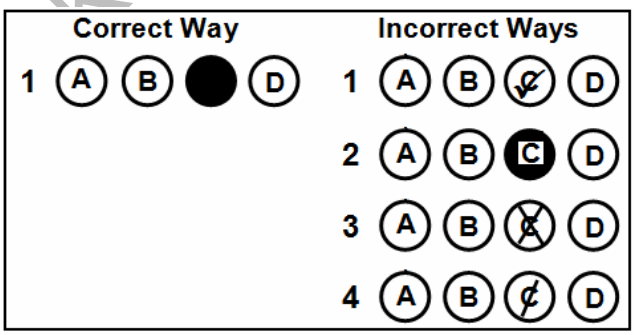
English Compulsory Paper I

Time: 50 minutes Marks: 25

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INSTRUCTIONS

1. Read each question carefully.
2. Answer the questions on the separate answer sheet provided. DO NOT write your answers on the question paper.
3. There are 100 answer numbers on the answer sheet. Use answer numbers 1 to 25 only.
4. In each question there are four choices A, B, C, D. Choose ONE. On the answer grid black out the circle for your choice with a pencil as shown below.



Candidate's Signature

5. If you want to change your answer, ERASE the first answer completely with a rubber, before blacking out a new circle.
6. DO NOT write anything in the answer grid. The computer only records what is in the circles.

Listening Comprehension Section

In this section you will hear two passages. Each one will be played two times.

Listen carefully to the first passage, and then read questions 1 to 6. You will have two minutes' reading time.

The passage will then be played again. You can make notes on your question paper.

When the passage has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have three and a half minutes to pencil in your answers.

Follow the instructions on the front page of Paper I to show which of the options, A, B, C, or D, you have selected for each question.

Listening Passage I

The passage describes the formation of fossils.

Source: Taken from BBC Earth

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Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

1. The speaker begins the passage by saying that

   A. fossils are an important part of nature.
   B. many types of fossil are found in nature.
   C. fossils represent remains of dinosaurs only.
   D. fossils help us to understand past experiences.

2. As per the explanation given by the speaker, which of the following **BEST** describes fossils?

   A. The bodies of dinosaurs and stems of plants
   B. The preserved dead bodies of animals and plants
   C. The decayed remains of softer tissues of animals and plants
   D. The rocks on which many minerals are deposited over a period

3. When an animal dies, its remains would **MOST LIKELY**

   A. rot away.
   B. get fossilized.
   C. be buried under soil.
   D. be thrown in the sea.

4. A dead animal becomes a fossil only when its body

   A. rots over a period of time.
   B. sinks in water after decaying.
   C. erodes immediately after its death.
   D. buries under soil soon after its death.

5. According to the speaker, which parts of a dead animal would **MOST LIKELY** become fossils?

   A. Teeth and bones
   B. Flesh and blood
   C. The entire body
   D. Various internal organs

6. An animal has the **BEST** chance of becoming a fossil when it is

   A. eaten by bacteria.
   B. infused by many minerals.
   C. buried in soil under seabed.
   D. chemically changed after its death.

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Now we will play the second passage. It will also be played two times.

Listen carefully to the first passage and then read questions 7 to 12. You will have two minutes reading time.

The passage will then be played again. You can make notes on your question paper.

When the passage has finished, enter your answers on the separate answer sheet provided to you. You will have three and a half minutes to pencil in your answers.

Listening Passage II

This passage narrates the description of Jakarta.

Source: Adapted from National Geographic Magazine

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Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

7. The introduction of Jakarta given by the speaker gives an impression of Jakarta's

   A. busy life and population.
   B. fascinating buildings and art.
   C. many communities and languages.
   D. wealth, luxury and way of dressing.

8. Which of the following phrases describes Jakarta **MOST ACCURATELY**?

   A. A city of great wealth
   B. A populated business centre
   C. A city of extreme poverty and climate
   D. A small city with history of war with Japan

9. The speaker says that Java is the most densely populated island in Indonesia. Which information is given immediately after this?

   A. People from many places have moved to Jakarta for trade.
   B. In Java, the wealthy employ drivers and domestic staff.
   C. The Dutch and the British came to Java for trade opportunities.
   D. All iconic buildings and business centres of the country are in Java.

10. According to the speaker, why did the Dutch and the British fight each other?

    A. For trading with Indonesia
    B. For taking control of Southeast Asia
    C. For taking control of the 17,500 islands
    D. For competing with Japan before the World War

11. It is necessary to have many cups of tea, share meals and meet several times with your business partner in Indonesia before finalising a business deal. This is because Indonesians

    A. want to observe their old customs.
    B. desire to show sincerity and decency.
    C. want to receive and give gifts and tokens.
    D. give importance to personal relationships.

12. From the description given by the speaker, we can infer that Bahasa Indonesia refers to the

    A. language of Indonesia.
    B. centre of business and trade.
    C. centre of sports and culture.
    D. overall culture of Indonesia.

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Reading Comprehension Section

You have 25 minutes for the reading comprehension section. This section has two passages, each followed by multiple choice questions. You are advised to spend approximately 12 minutes on each of the given passages.

Read the passage carefully and then answer the multiple choice questions which follow.

Reading Passage I

Climate is the long-term pattern of weather in a particular area. Weather can change from hour to hour, day to day, month to month or even from year to year. Because climates are mostly constant, living things can adapt to them. Polar bears have adapted to stay warm in polar climates, while cacti have evolved to hold onto water in dry climates. The enormous variety of life on Earth results in large part from the variety of climates that exist.

Climates do change, however — they just change very slowly, over hundreds or even thousands of years. As climates change, organisms that live in the area must adapt, relocate, or risk going extinct.

Earth's climate has changed many times. Earth has also experienced several major ice ages — at least four in the past 500,000 years. During these periods, Earth's temperature decreased, causing an expansion of ice sheets and glaciers. The most recent Ice Age began about 2 million years ago and peaked about 20,000 years ago.

Some human activities also affect the climate change by releasing greenhouse gases — burning fossil fuels for transportation and electricity, or using agricultural technology that increases production, for instance. Trees absorb carbon dioxide, so cutting down forests for timber or development contributes to the greenhouse effect. So do factories that emit pollutants into the atmosphere.

Many scientists are worried that these activities are causing dramatic and dangerous changes in Earth's climate. Average temperatures around the world have risen since the late 1870s, when scientists began tracking them. The seven warmest years of the 20th century occurred in the 1980s and 1990s. This warming trend may be a sign that the greenhouse effect is increasing because of human activity. This climate change is often referred to as "global warming."

Pakistan makes a tiny contribution to total global greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions, less than 1% (among the lowest in the world), but it is among the countries most vulnerable to climate change, and it has very low technical and financial capacity to adapt to its adverse impacts. The effects of climate change and global warming on Pakistan (the melting of glaciers in the Himalayas) is threatening the volumetric flow rate of many of the most important rivers of Pakistan. In Pakistan, such effects are projected to impact millions of lives.

A climate vulnerability report released by environmental think-tank, Germanwatch, counted Pakistan among the three countries most affected by extreme weather events in 2012. The extreme weather calamities like earthquakes, floods and disturbance in sea level have caused Pakistan to lose many precious lives, food sources and property.

Source: Adapted from National Geographic and The Express Tribune

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

13. The main difference between weather and climate is that

    A. climate change is more frequent than change in weather.
    B. plants can adapt to certain mild climates and all kinds of weather.
    C. climate does not change frequently whereas weather keeps changing.
    D. some animals can survive in extreme weather but not in extreme climate.

14. In the event of climate change, all species who survive have to

    A. adapt.
    B. revive.
    C. take risks.
    D. live in isolation.

15. Which of the following describes ice age **MOST ACCURATELY**?

    A. Earth's temperature constantly remains extreme.
    B. Glaciers melt and freeze over a short period of time.
    C. Earth's temperature decreases and snow accumulates.
    D. For 20,000 years temperature constantly remains very low.

16. The purpose of paragraph 4 is to

    A. describe how greenhouse gases affect climate.
    B. highlight how species survive in extreme conditions.
    C. describe how agricultural activities negatively impact crops.
    D. highlight the destructive impact of human activities on environment.

17. Paragraphs 4 and 5 are organised to show

    A. chronology.
    B. general details.
    C. cause and effect.
    D. order of importance.

18. The rise of average temperatures across the world indicates

    A. an increase in greenhouse effect.
    B. the threat of the return of ice age.
    C. that the earth's temperature was normal before 1980.
    D. threats faced by the world due to agricultural technology.

19. According to this passage, what would produce **MOST** greenhouse gases?

    A. Preservation and utilization of fossils
    B. The use of electricity in transportation
    C. Deforestation and burning of fossil fuels
    D. The use of chemicals in industries

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Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.

Reading Passage II

It was Maeterlinck who introduced me to the bee. I mean, in the psychical and in the poetical way. I had had a business introduction earlier. It was when I was a boy. It is strange that I should remember a formality like that so long; it must be nearly sixty years.

Bee scientists always speak of the bee as she. It is because all the important bees are of that sex. In the hive there is one married bee, called the queen; she has more than fifty thousand children; of these, about one hundred are sons; the rest are daughters. Some of the daughters are young maids, some are old maids, and all are virgins and remain so.

There are always a few royal heirs in stock and ready to take the place of the queen — ready and more than anxious to do it, although she is their own mother. These girls are kept by themselves, and are regally fed and tended from birth. No other bees get such fine food as they get, or live such a high and luxurious life. By consequence they are larger and longer and sleeker than their working sisters. And they have a curved sting, shaped like a scimitar, while the others have a straight one.

A common bee will sting anyone or anybody, but a royalty stings royalties only. A common bee will sting and kill another common bee but when it is necessary to kill the queen, other ways are employed. When a queen has grown old and slack and does not lay enough eggs, one of her royal daughters is allowed to come to attack her, the rest of the bees looking on at the duel and seeing fair play. It is a duel with the curved stings. If one of the fighters gets hard pressed and gives it up and runs, she is brought back and must try again — once, maybe twice; then, if she runs yet once more for her life, judicial death is her portion; her children pack themselves into a ball around her person and hold her in that compact grip for two or three days, until she starves to death or is suffocated. Meantime the victor bee is receiving royal honours and performing the one royal function — laying eggs.

After the queen, the personage next in importance in the hive is the virgin. The virgins are fifty thousand or one hundred thousand in number, and they are the workers, the labourers. No work is done, in the hive or out of it, save by them. The males do not work; the queen does no work, unless laying eggs is considered work, but it does not seem so to me.

Source: Adapted from 'The Bee' by Mark Twain

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Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

20. According to paragraph 2, the scientists refer to bees as 'she' because

A there are no male bees in a beehive.
B. female bees live a high and luxurious life.
C. one of them could be chosen as the queen.
D. most bees which are of consequence are females.

21. According to paragraph 4, which of the following ways is employed to kill the queen bee?

A. She is thrown out of the nest.
B. The queen's sting is removed.
C. The male bee stings the queen.
D. A royal heir has a duel with the queen.

22. "The heirs are regally fed and tended from birth."

Which of the following words means the same as 'regally' in this statement?

A. Richly
B. Rapidly
C. Royally
D. Repeatedly

23. The main idea of paragraph 4 is to

A. describe the work distribution of bees.
B. explain how bees replace their queen.
C. explain the hierarchy in the social set-up of bees.
D. describe how bees reproduce and prepare for fight.

24. According to the hierarchy, virgins receive the next importance to the queen as they

A. kill other bees.
B. do not lay eggs.
C. have a straight sting.
D. form the major workforce.

25. The main purpose of the entire passage is to describe

A. how bees survive.
B. how bees reproduce.
C. social set-up of bees.
D. physical description of bees.

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